

The infographic is titled "The Power of Digital" in a large, bold, sans-serif font. Below the title, there are three main visual elements: a person surfing on a rocket, a laptop with stacks of money, and a bar chart. The person is a stylized figure with red hair, wearing a red shirt and red pants, surfing on a red and yellow rocket. The laptop is open, and several stacks of red banknotes are emerging from it. To the right of the laptop is a bar chart with five bars of increasing height, colored in shades of red and yellow. Below the bar chart, there are two circular icons: a red one with a white dot and a yellow one with a black dot. At the bottom, there are two logos: "AVAADA" with a blue and green wave icon, and "Lenskart" with a green and yellow eye icon. Below the logos, there are two numbers: "1,661" and "1,231". Below the numbers, there are two company names: "Avaada Energy" and "Lenskart".

1,661
Avaada Energy

1,231
Lenskart



spite strong revenues and market presence, are still operating with relatively thin cash buffers. As funding slows, the reality is forcing a reset—companies with shorter runways will have to cut costs, fix unit economics, or seek strategic capital to stay afloat.

Investors feel the shift is less about a lack of money and more about how it is being deployed. As Anirudh Garg, Partner at Venture Capital firm BEENEXT points out, there is still substantial dry powder in the system, but the bar for investment has risen sharply, especially for large growth rounds. This recalibration

That shift is also redefining what kinds of risk investors are willing to underwrite. Garg notes that high-burn strategies are still viable—but only for clear category leaders with a credible, time-bound path to profitability. “There is still some leeway in sectors with massive outcome potential (AI infrastructure, deep tech, fintech, etc.), but even there, profitability cannot be theoretical — it must be visible,” he said.

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